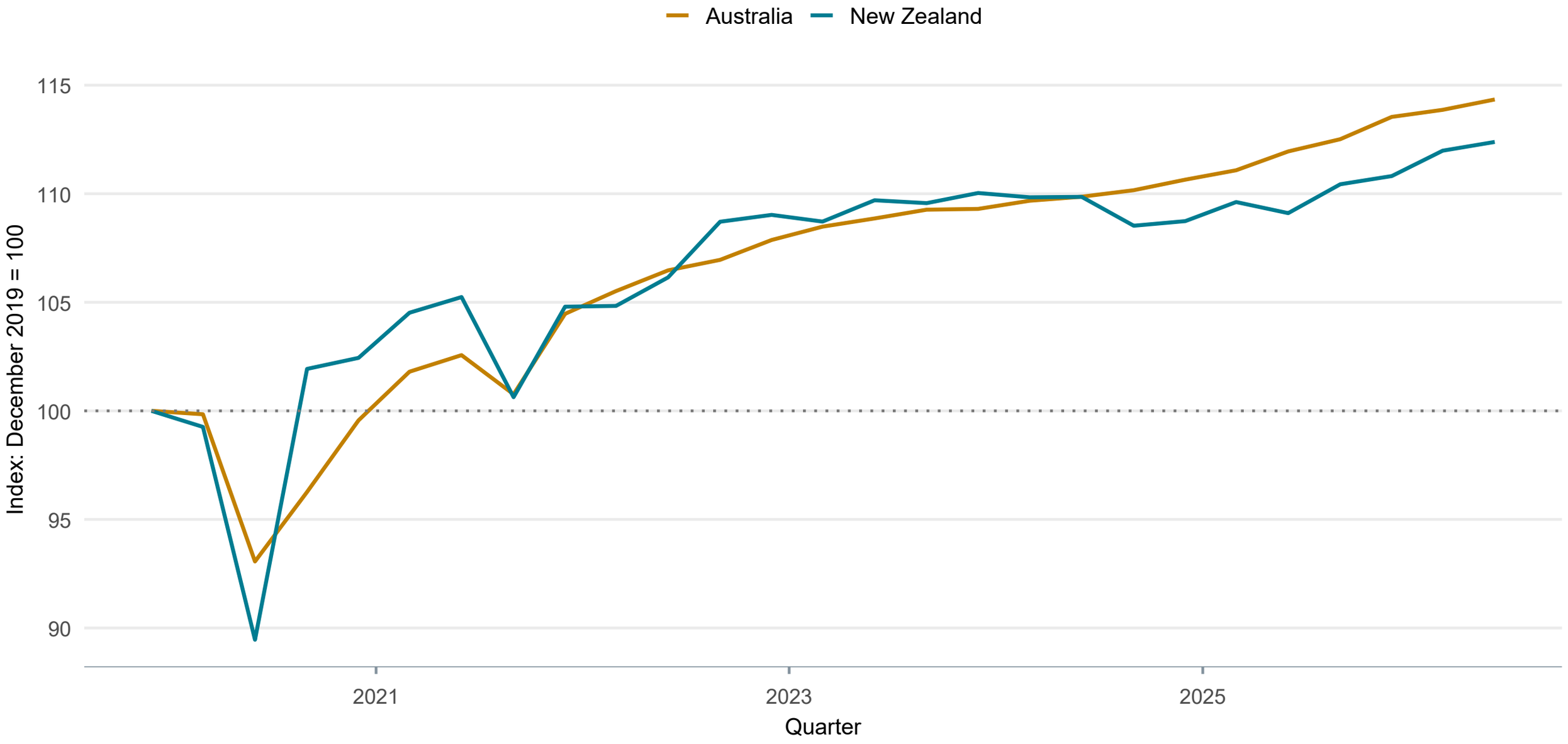
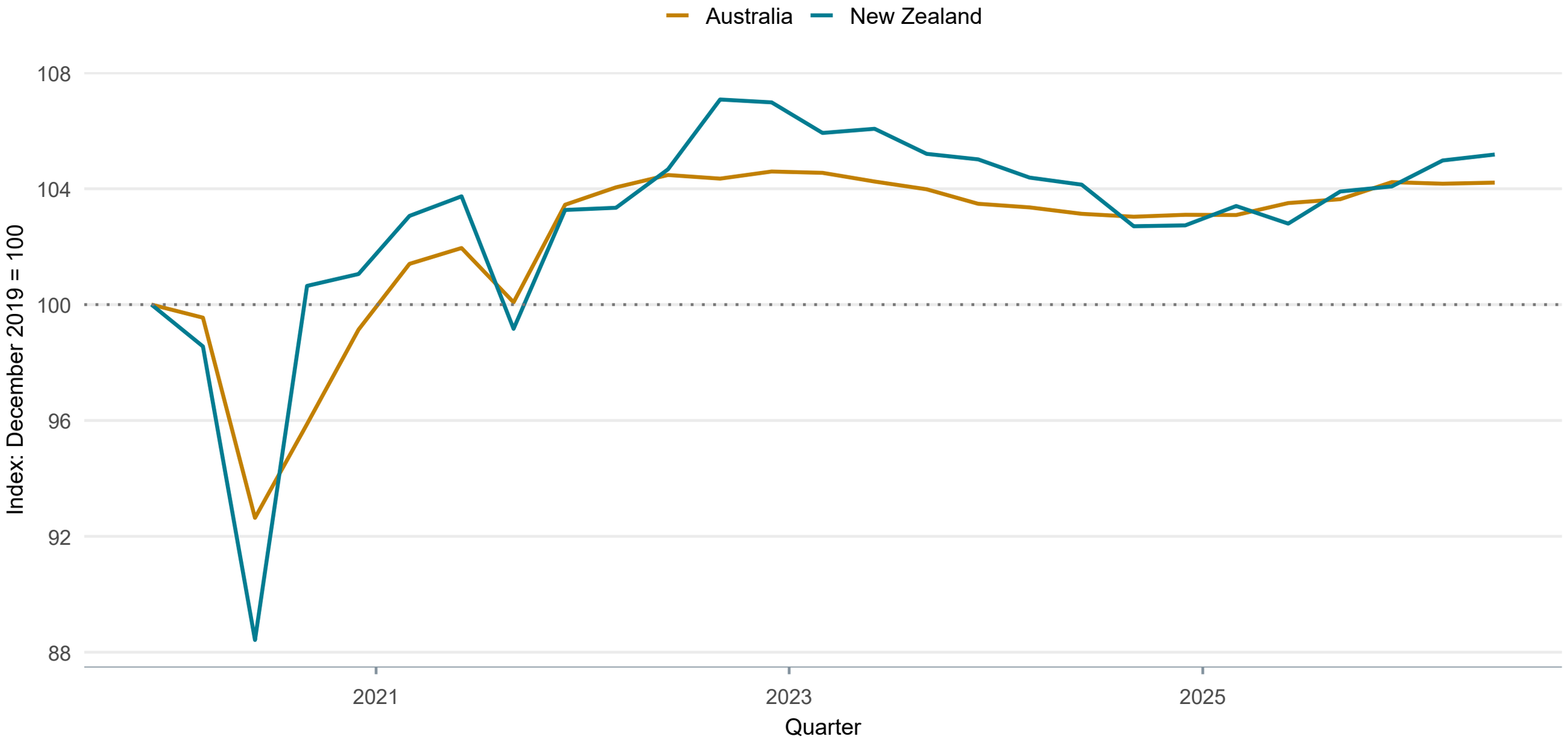
# The economies grew; growth per person was much weaker



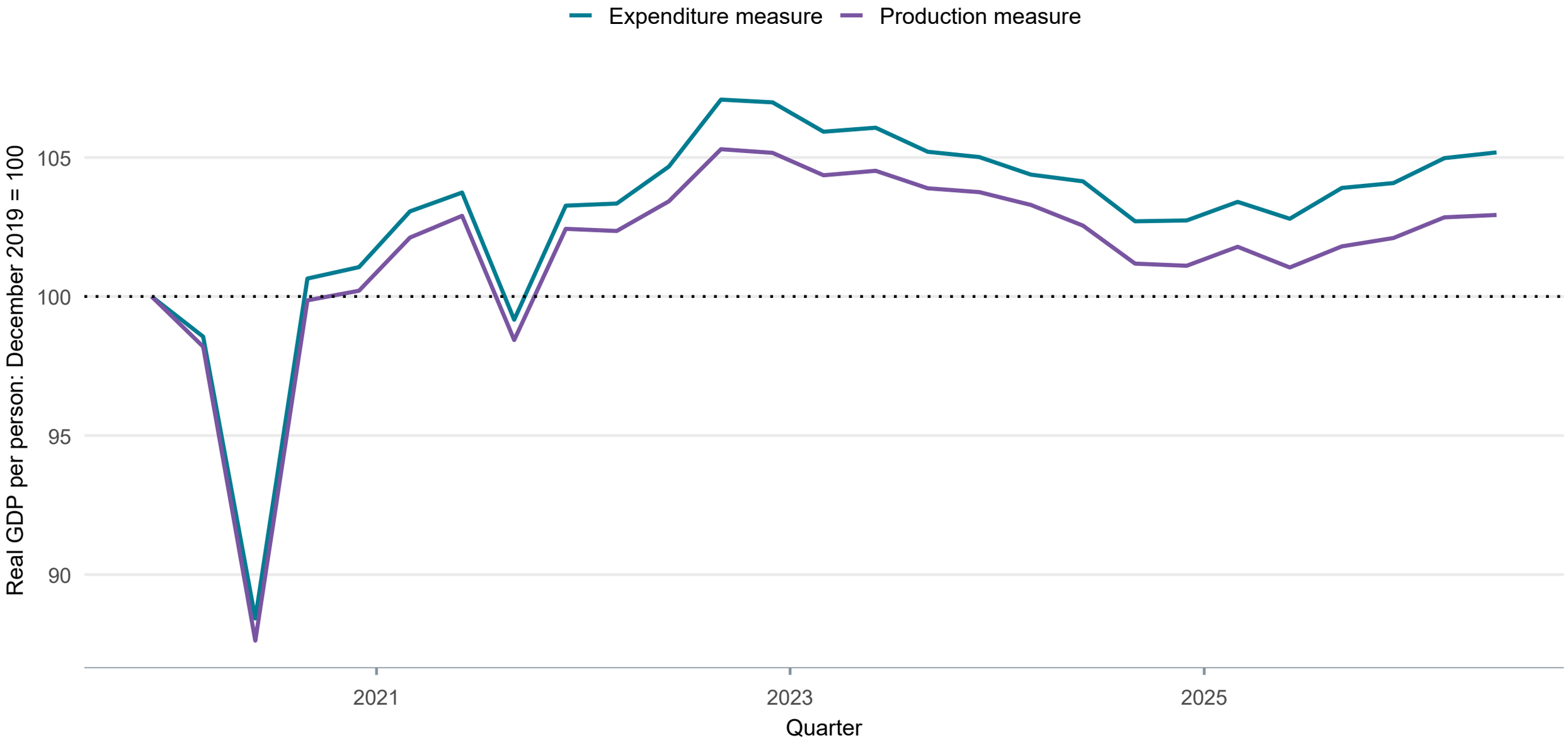

Sources: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV; ABS June 2026 Table 1. Real, seasonally adjusted expenditure GDP. Indices compare growth, not income levels.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# GDP per person has barely moved since the 2023 election



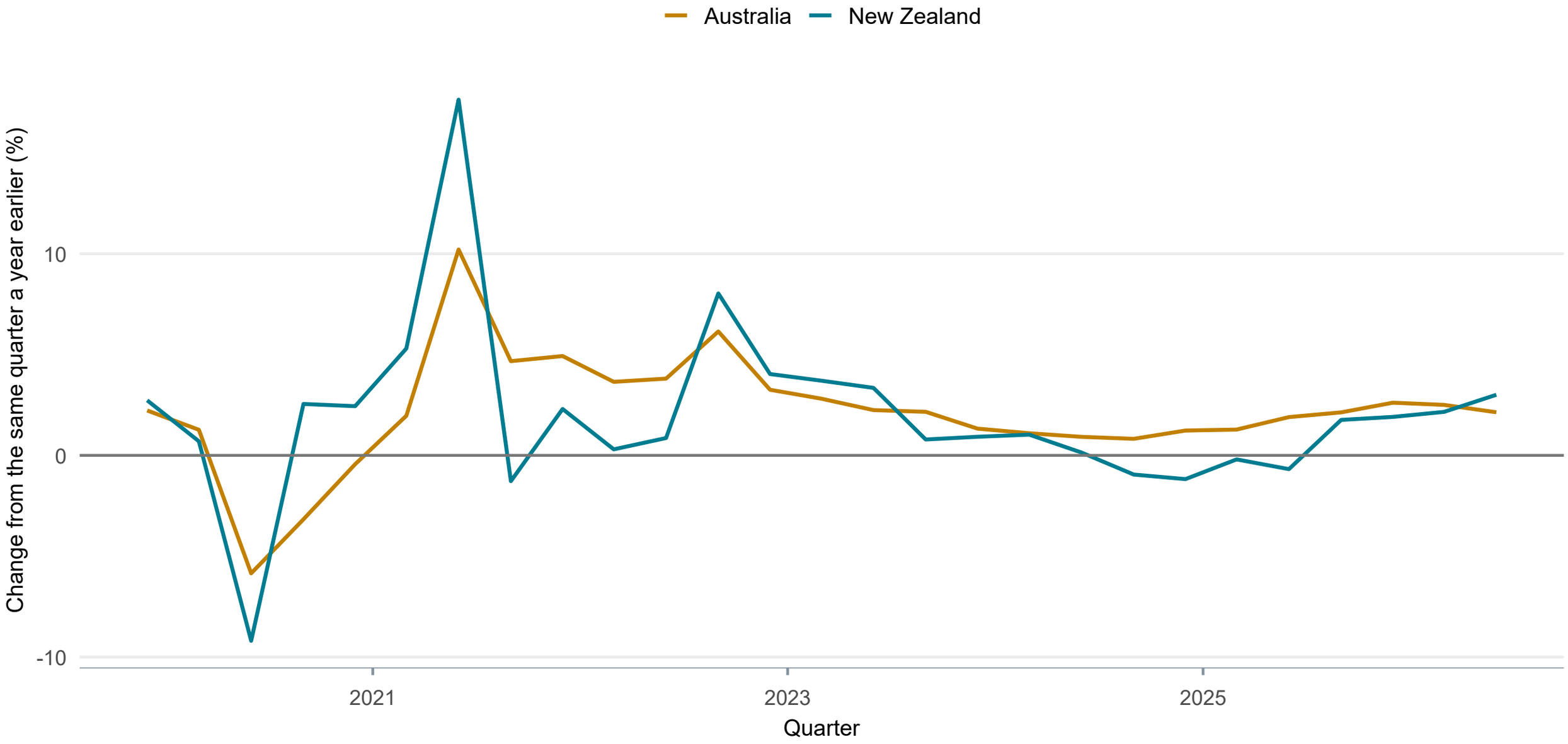

Sources: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV; ABS June 2026 Table 1. Real, seasonally adjusted expenditure GDP. Indices compare growth, not income levels.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# New Zealand GDP measures tell different recovery stories



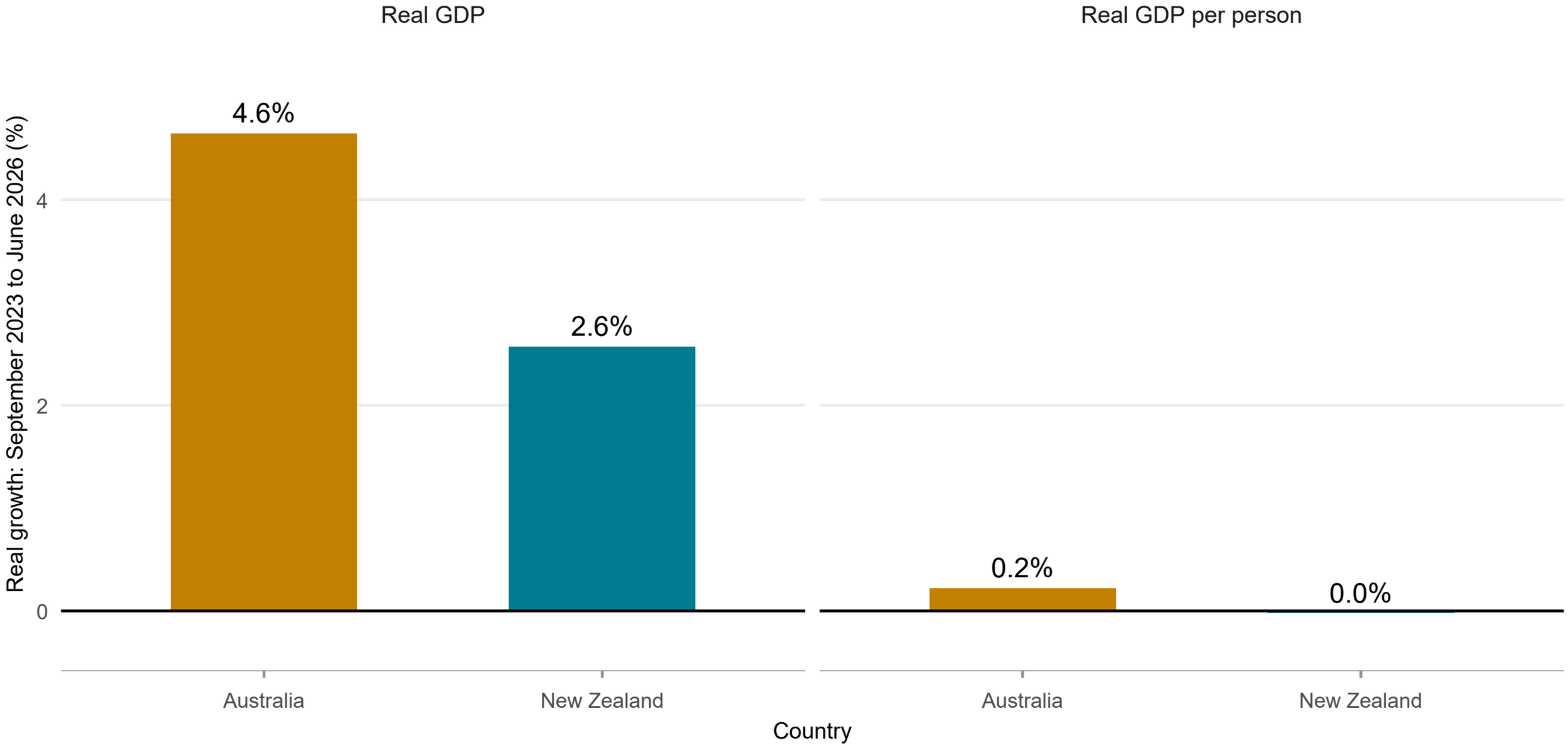

Source: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV. Production is the NZ headline; expenditure is used for the ABS comparison.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Recent recovery is not the same as a strong whole term



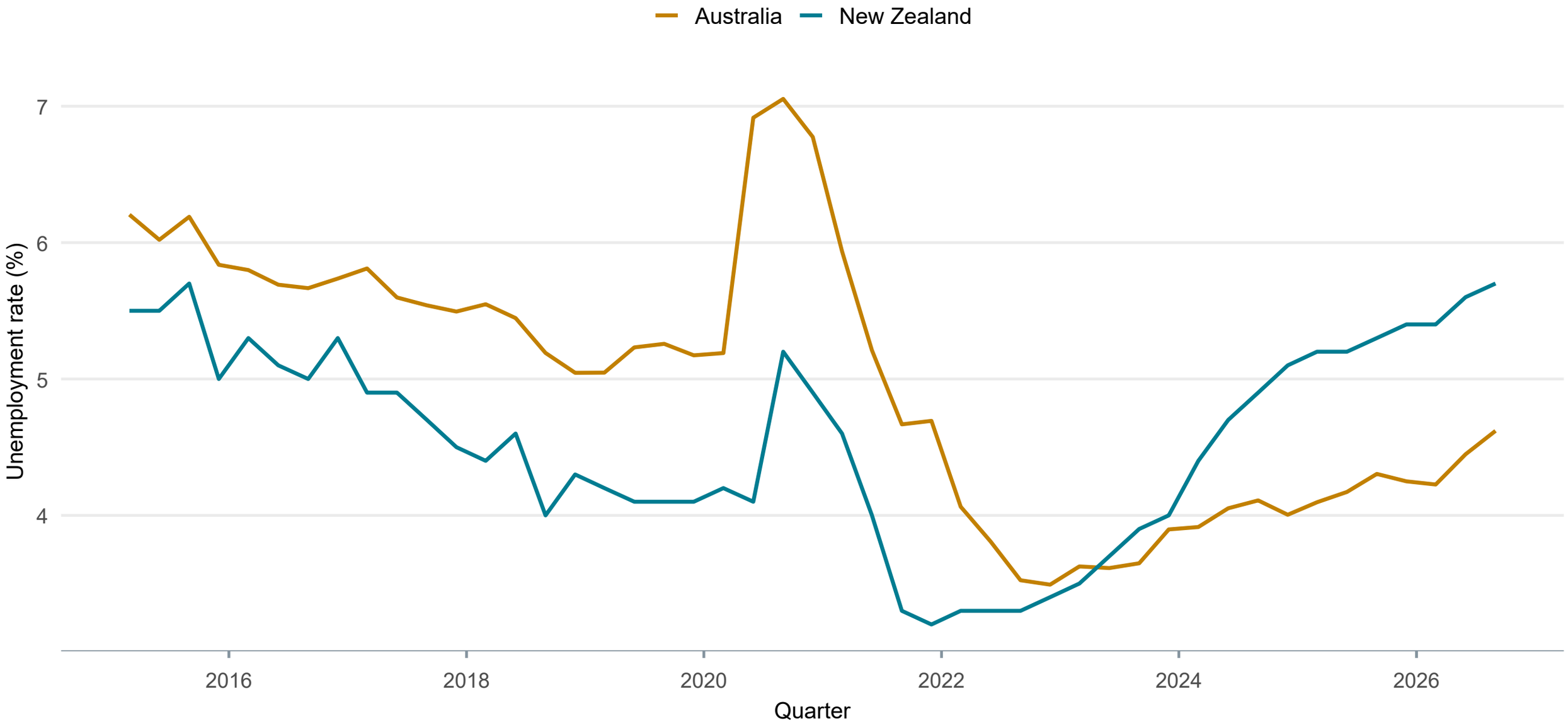

Sources: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV; ABS June 2026 Table 1. Real, seasonally adjusted expenditure GDP. Year-on-year growth; not annual-average growth.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Since September 2023, per-person output is roughly flat



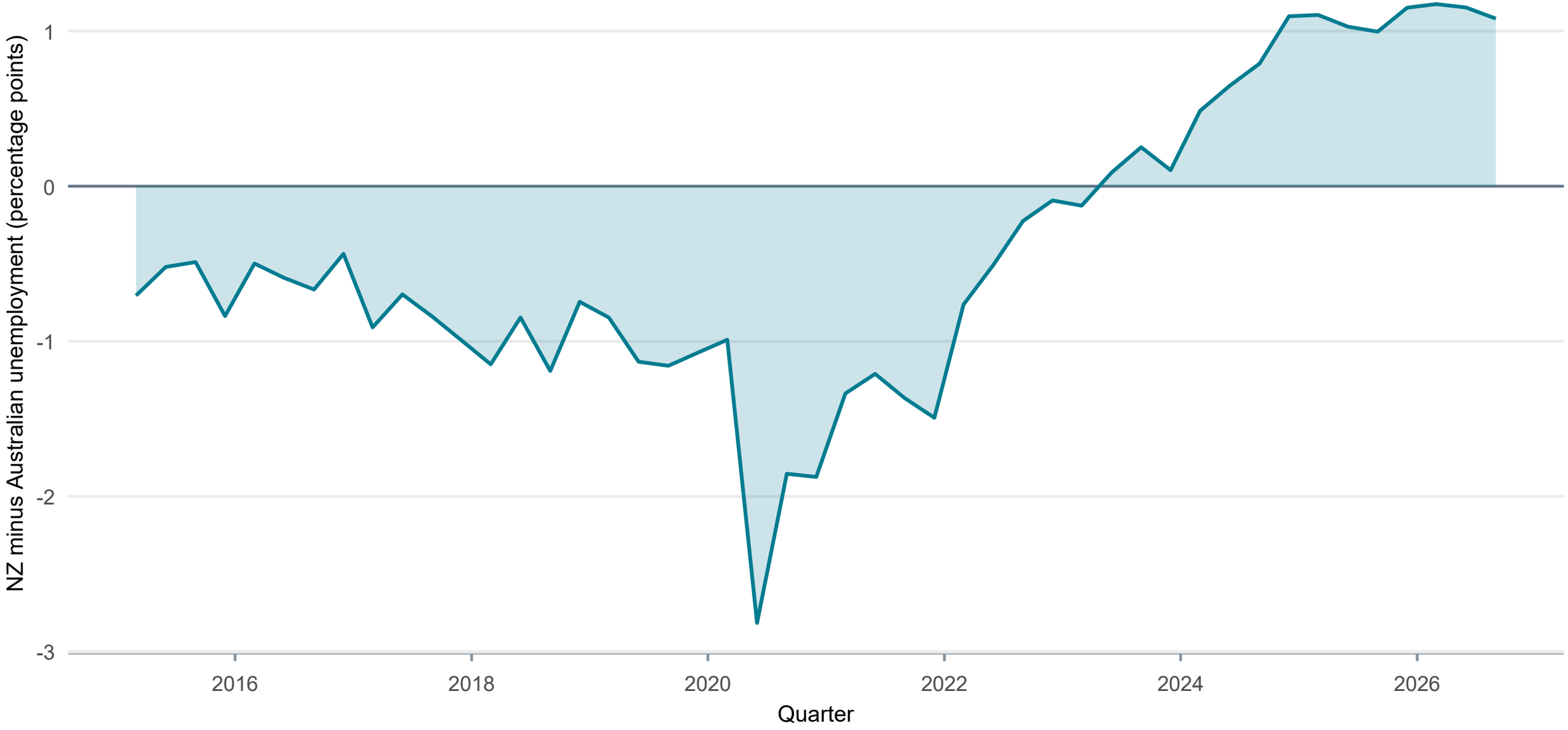

Sources: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV; ABS June 2026 Table 1. Real, seasonally adjusted expenditure GDP. This aligns dates; it does not identify the causal effect of either government.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# New Zealand unemployment has risen further



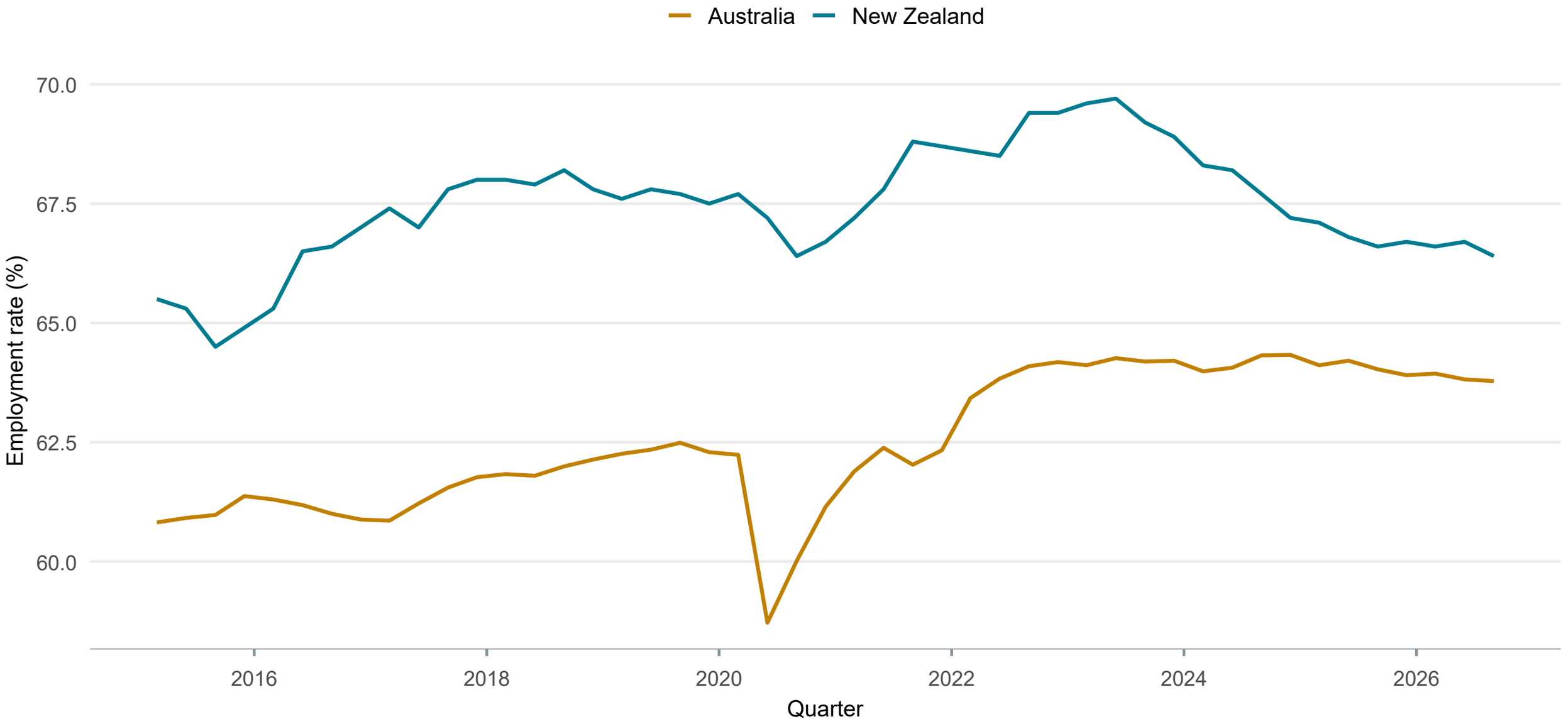

Sources: Stats NZ HLFS, September 2026; ABS Labour Force Table 1, September 2026. Seasonally adjusted, age 15+.
Australian observations are averages of three monthly rates; national survey scope and composition differ.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# The unemployment gap has turned against New Zealand



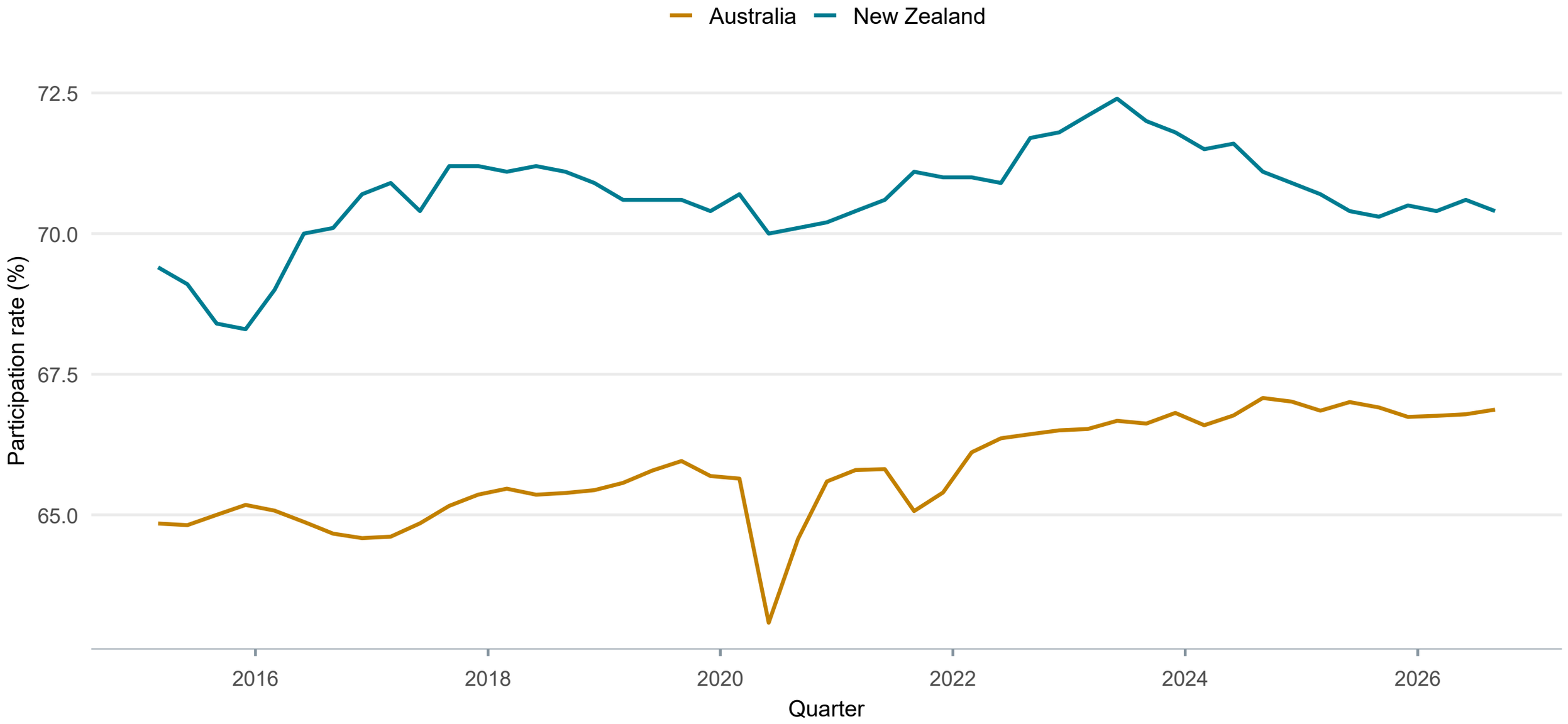

Sources: Stats NZ HLFS; ABS Labour Force. Australia: quarterly average of monthly seasonally adjusted rates.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Higher unemployment coexists with a higher employment rate



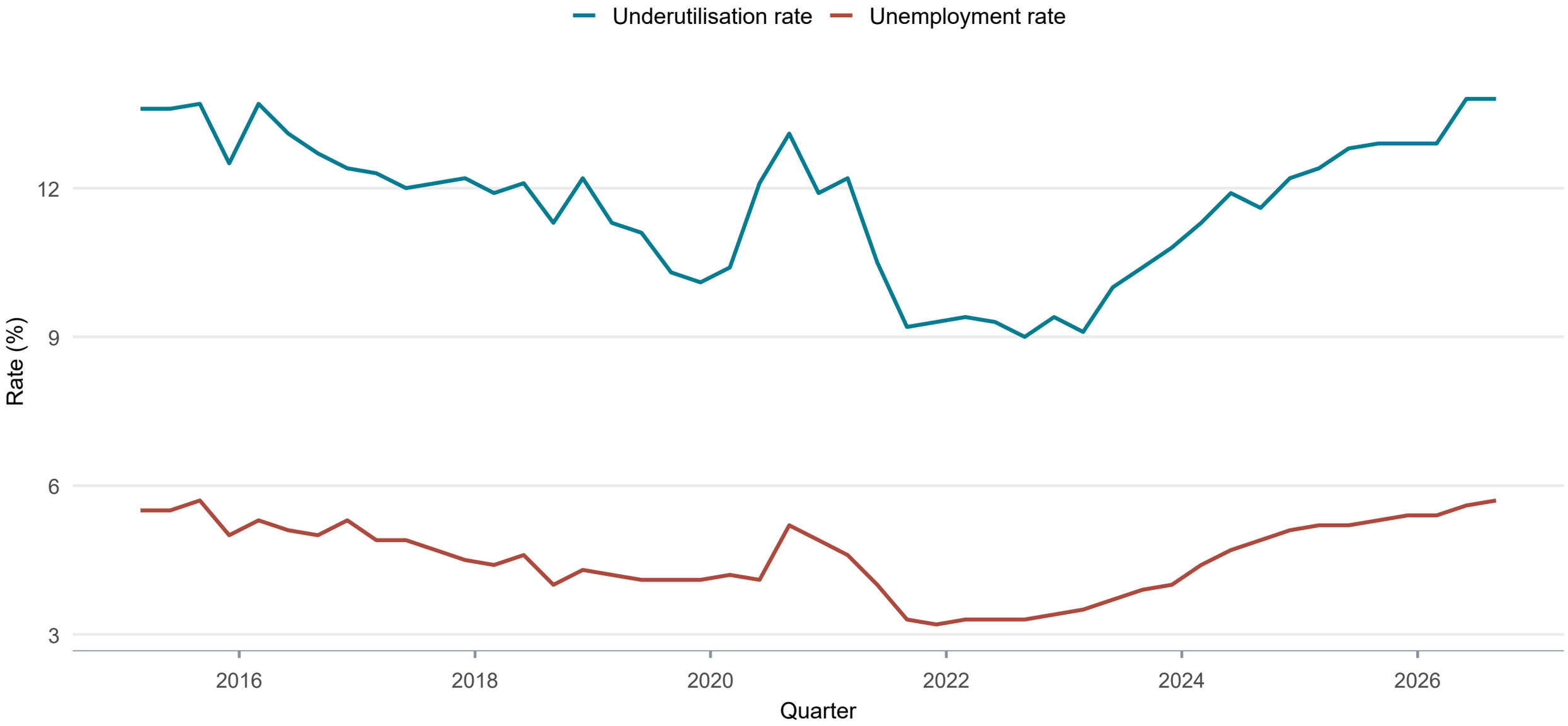

Sources: Stats NZ HLFS, September 2026; ABS Labour Force Table 1, September 2026. Seasonally adjusted, age 15+.
Australian observations are averages of three monthly rates; national survey scope and composition differ.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# New Zealand has a larger share of adults in the labour force



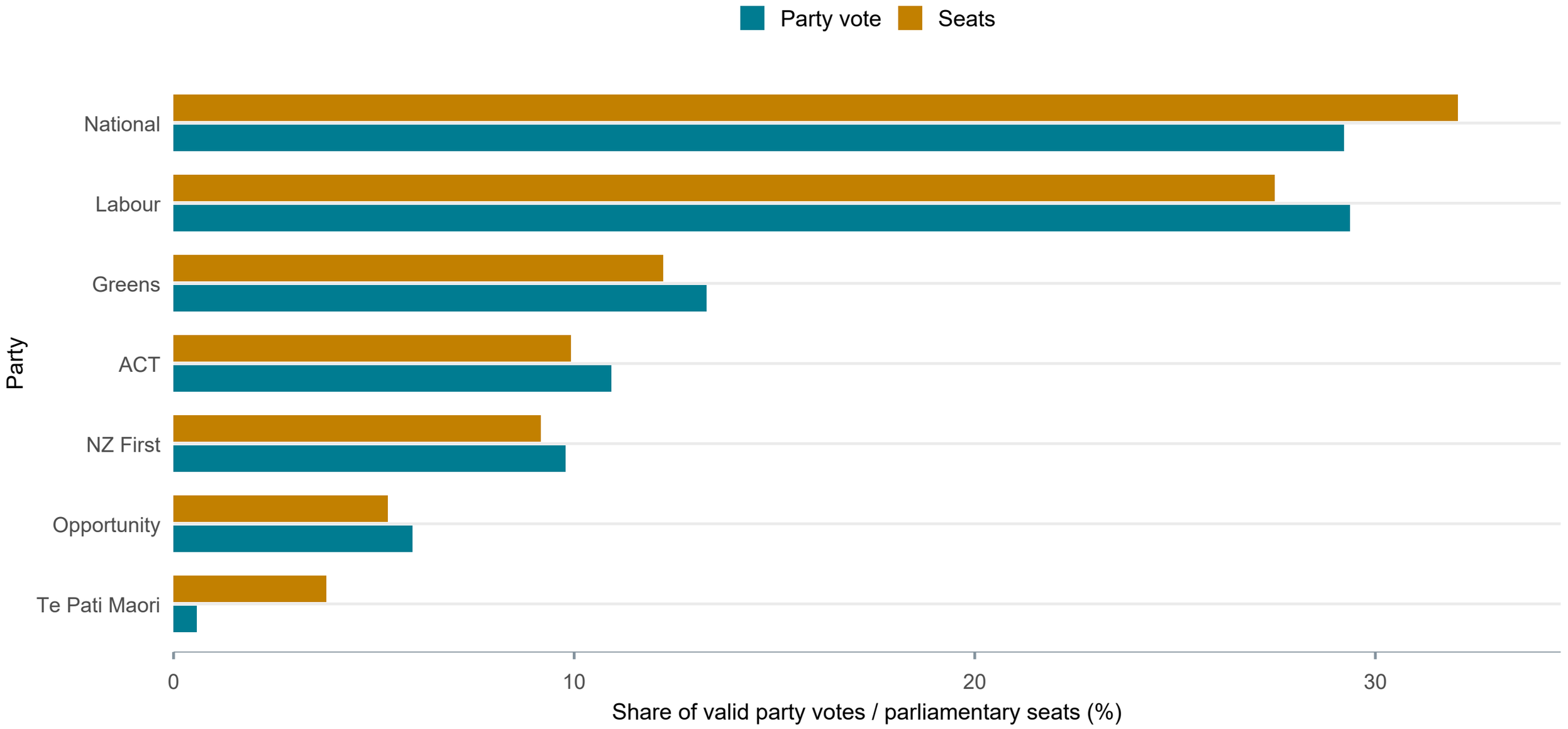

Sources: Stats NZ HLFS, September 2026; ABS Labour Force Table 1, September 2026. Seasonally adjusted, age 15+.
Australian observations are averages of three monthly rates; national survey scope and composition differ.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Unemployment captures only part of unused labour capacity



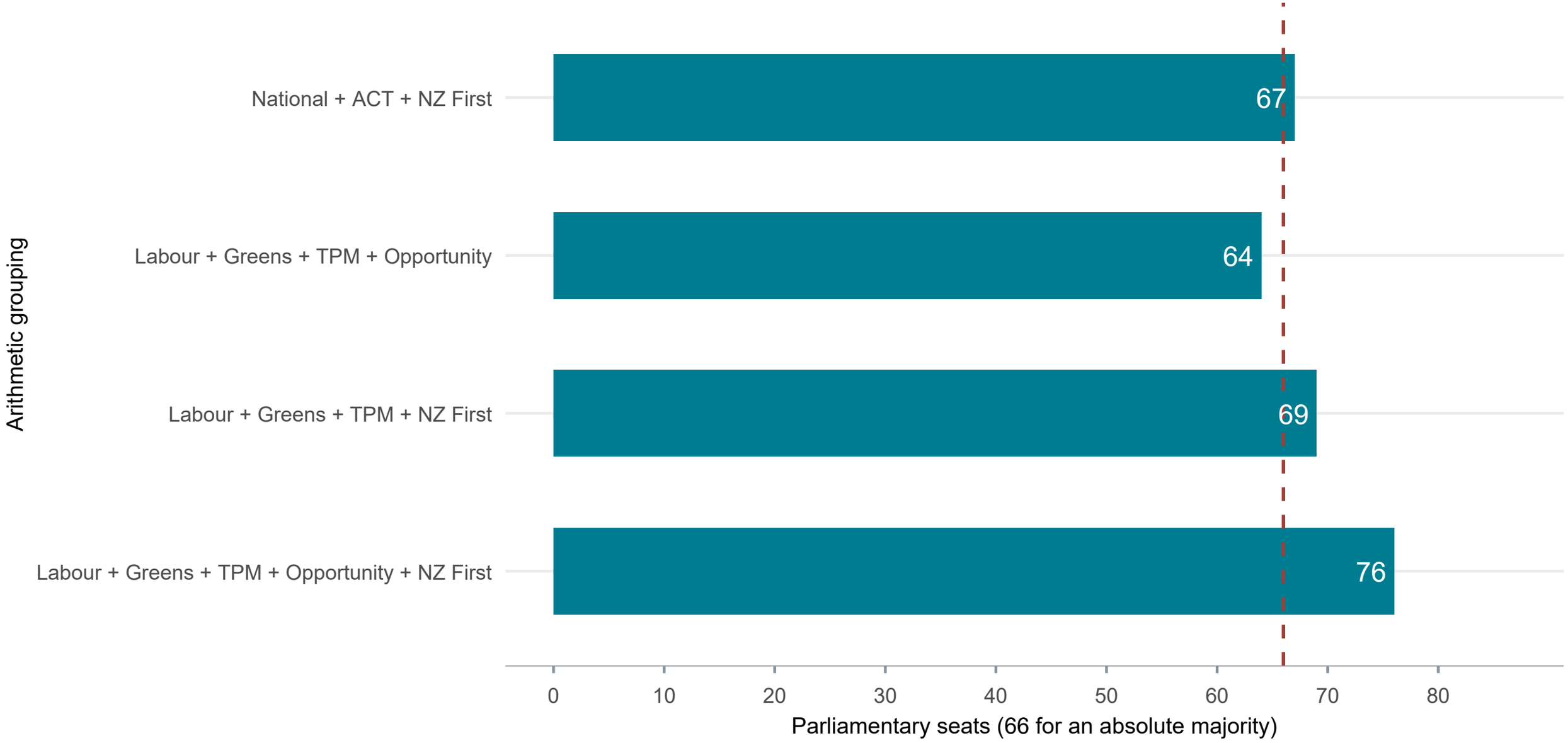

Source: Stats NZ September 2026 HLFS. Underutilisation includes unemployed, underemployed and potential labour force.
The underutilisation denominator is the extended labour force; the unemployment denominator is the labour force.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Party votes and seats differ because of overhangs



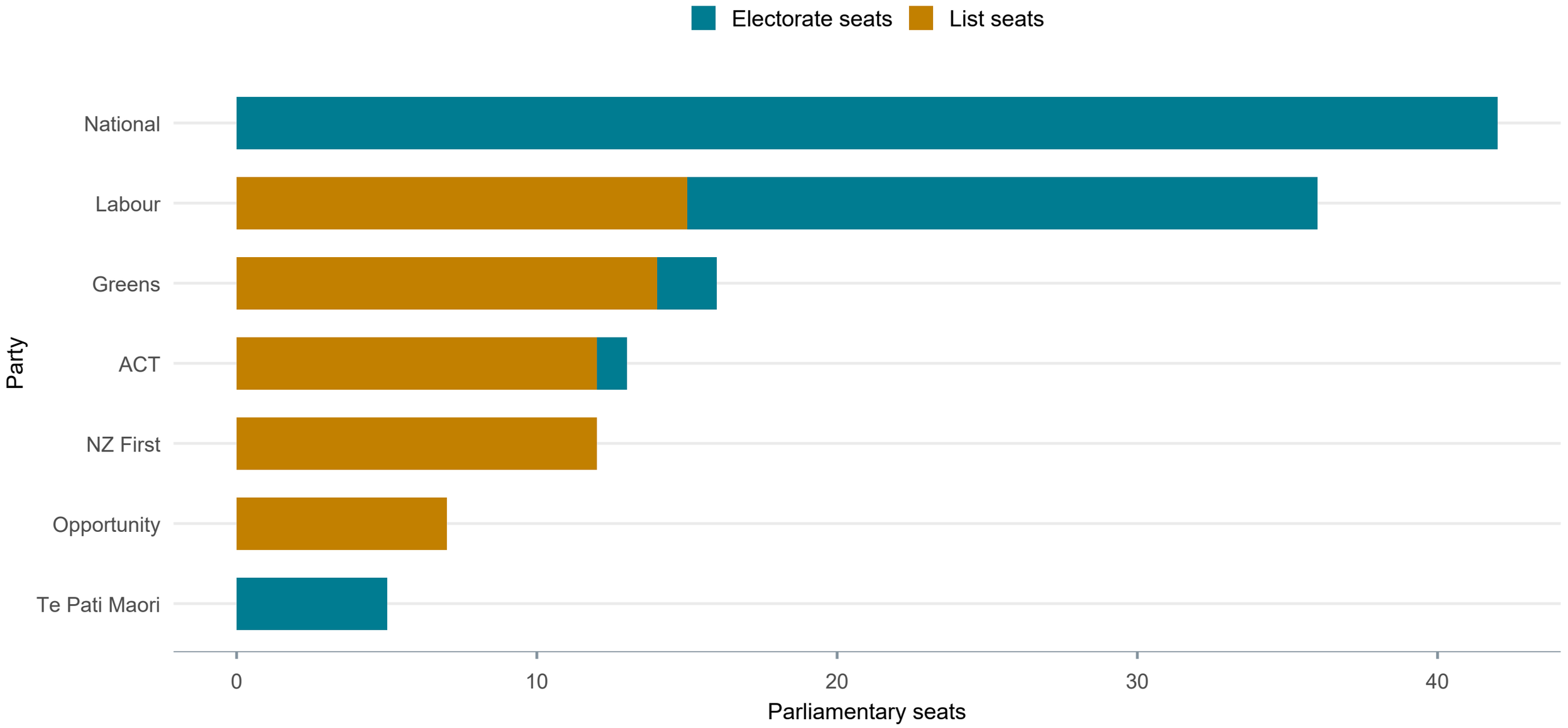

Source: Electoral Commission preliminary results, 7 November 2026. 131 seats, including 11 above the usual 120.
Percentages calculated from exact counts; special votes excluded. Official results due 27 November.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# The incumbent bloc has 67 of 131 preliminary seats



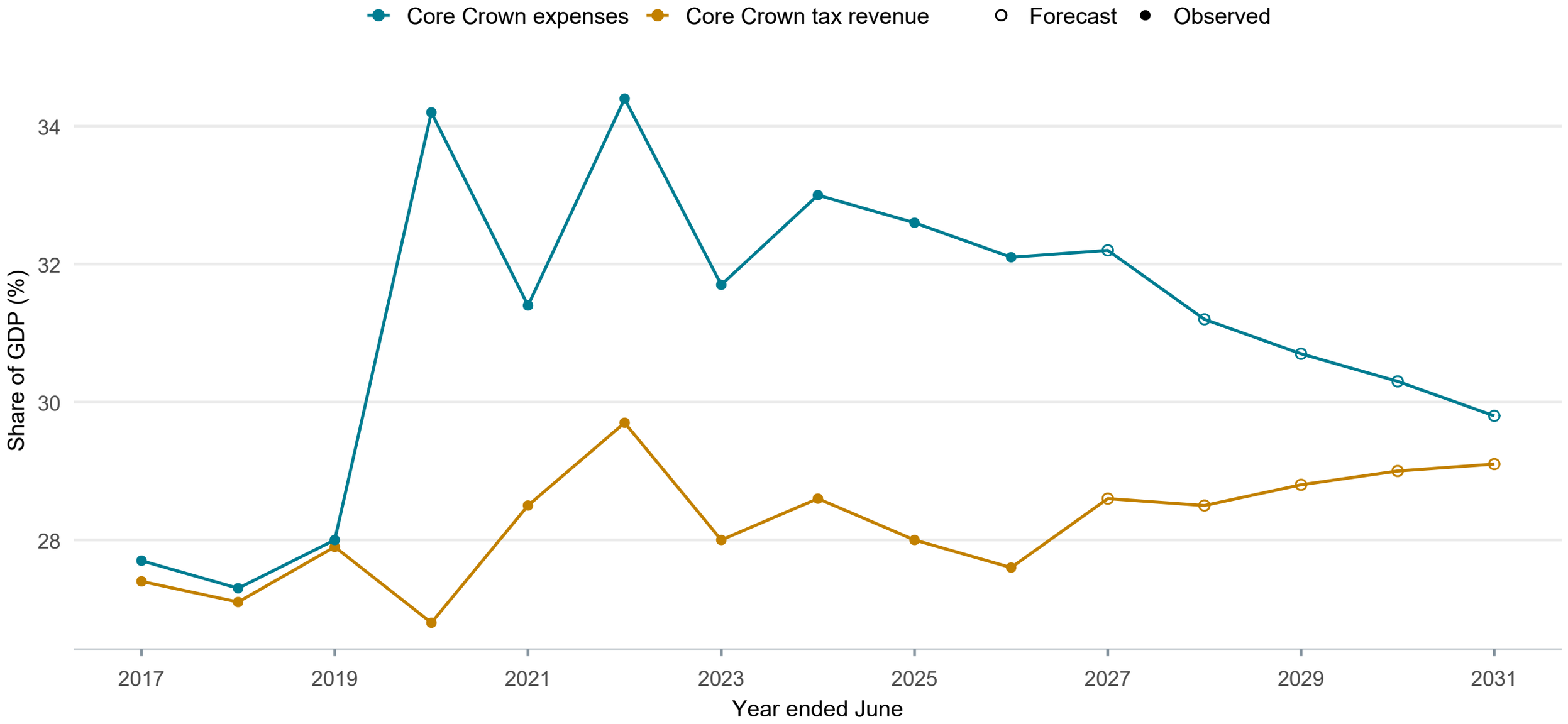

Source: Electoral Commission preliminary results. TPM = Te Pati Maori. Groups are arithmetic examples, not negotiated agreements.
Special votes can change party entitlements, electorate winners, total seats and the majority threshold.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# National has no list seats in the preliminary allocation



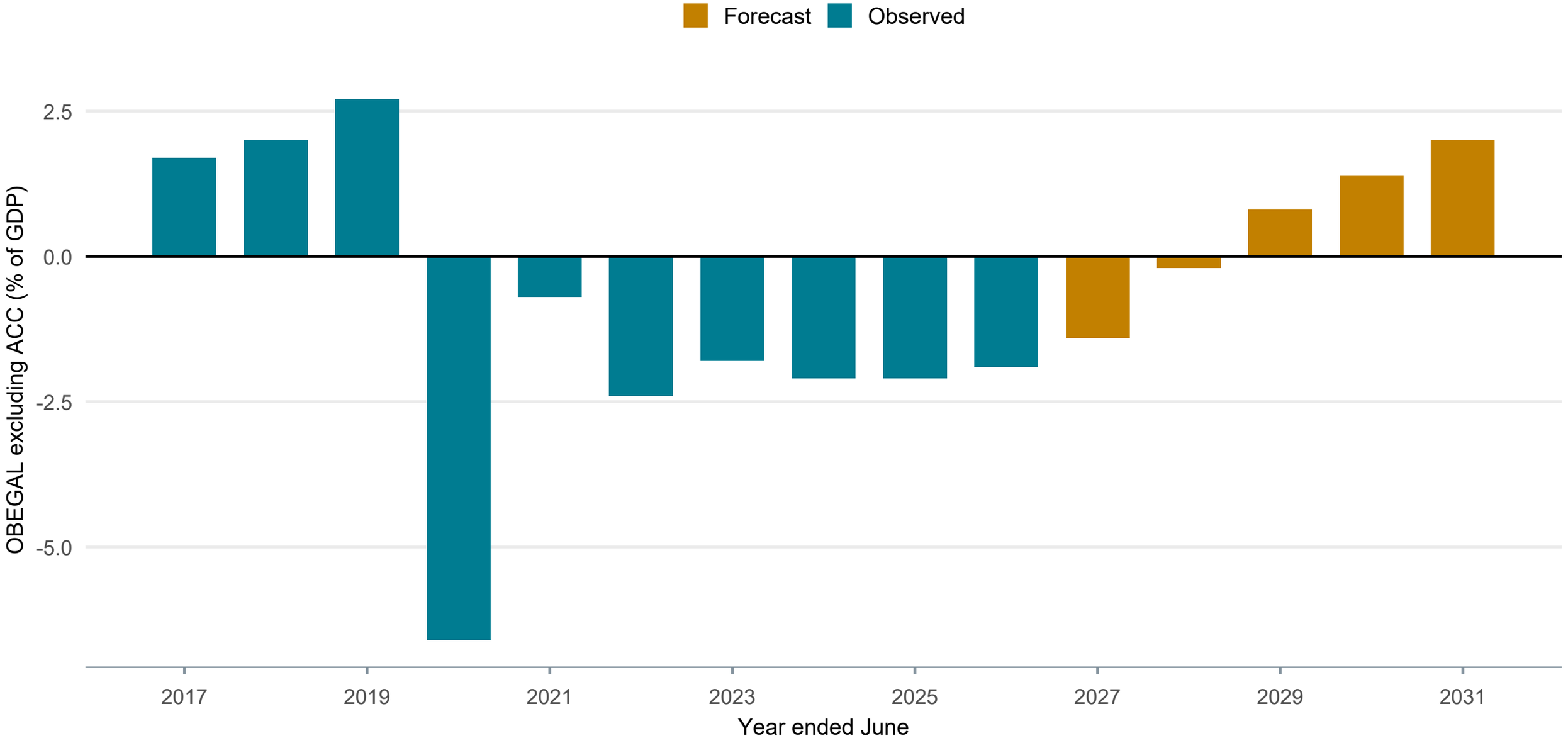

Source: Electoral Commission preliminary results. Losing an electorate does not by itself exclude a candidate from Parliament.
A list candidate needs room in the party entitlement after electorate MPs have been included.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Coalition choices sit inside a constrained fiscal outlook



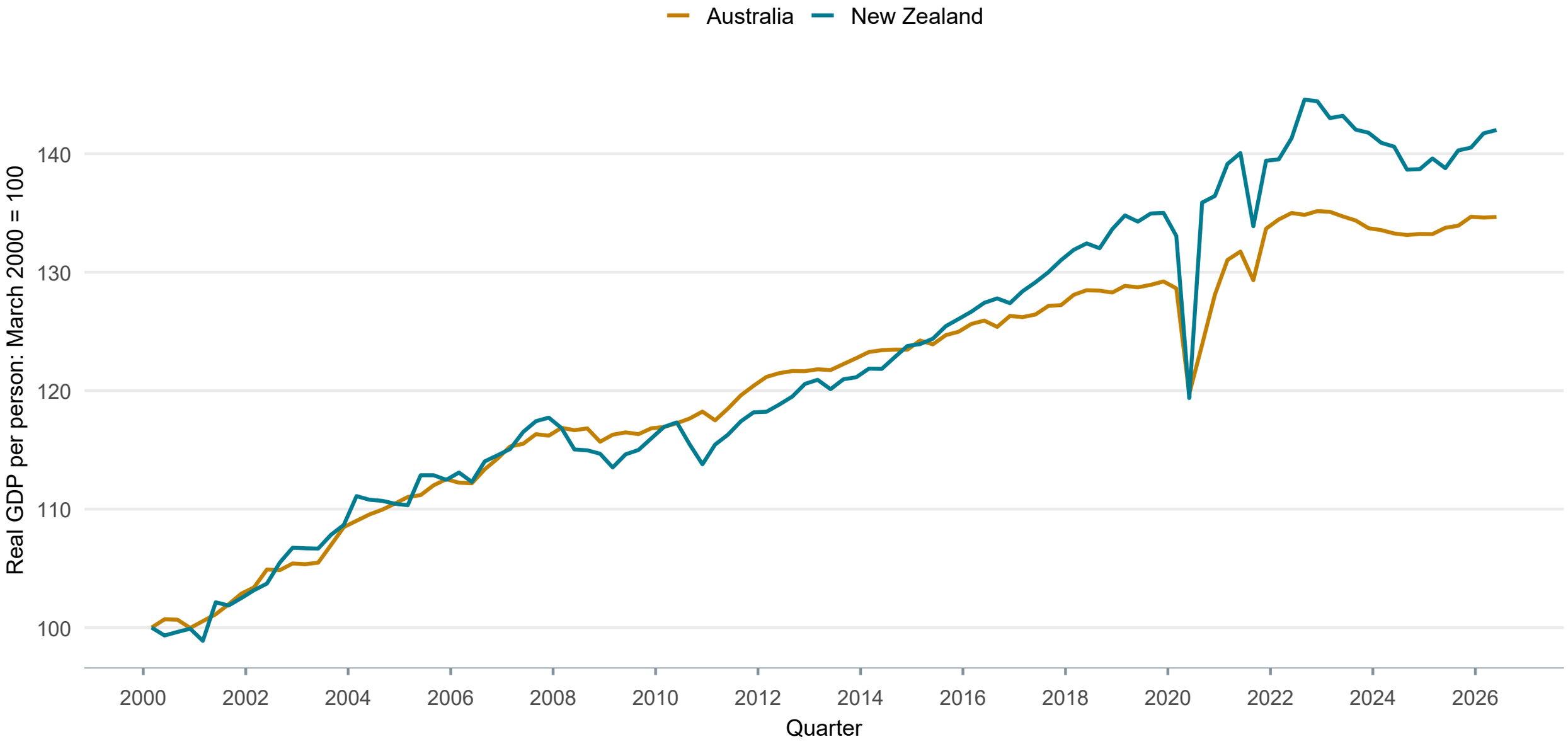

Source: NZ Treasury PREFU September 2026, Fiscal Time Series. Open markers are forecasts; filled markers actual/unaudited actual.
Core Crown tax revenue excludes other revenue: the distance between these lines is not the operating balance.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# The operating-balance improvement is largely a forecast



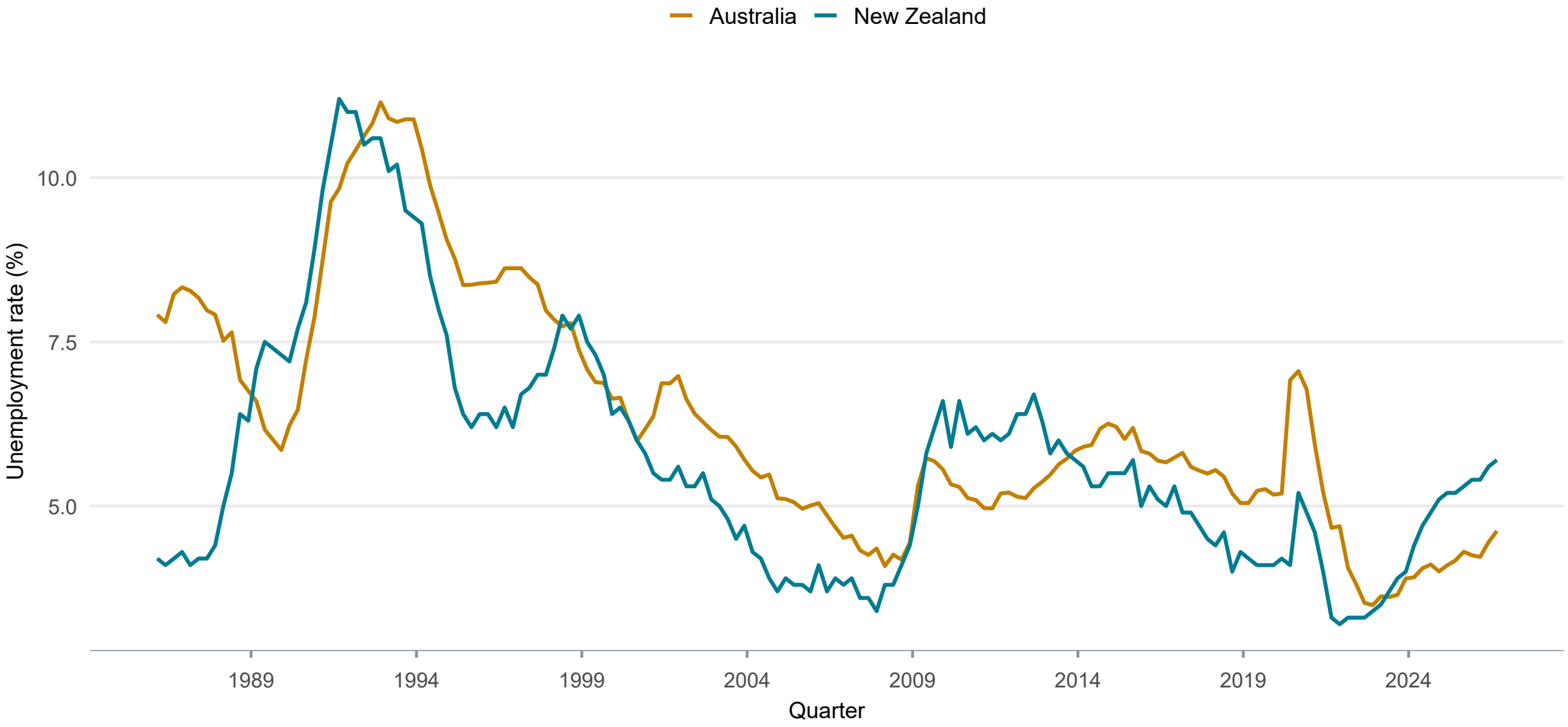

Source: NZ Treasury PREFU September 2026, Fiscal Time Series. Forecasts are conditional Treasury projections, not realised savings.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# A longer view changes the growth comparison



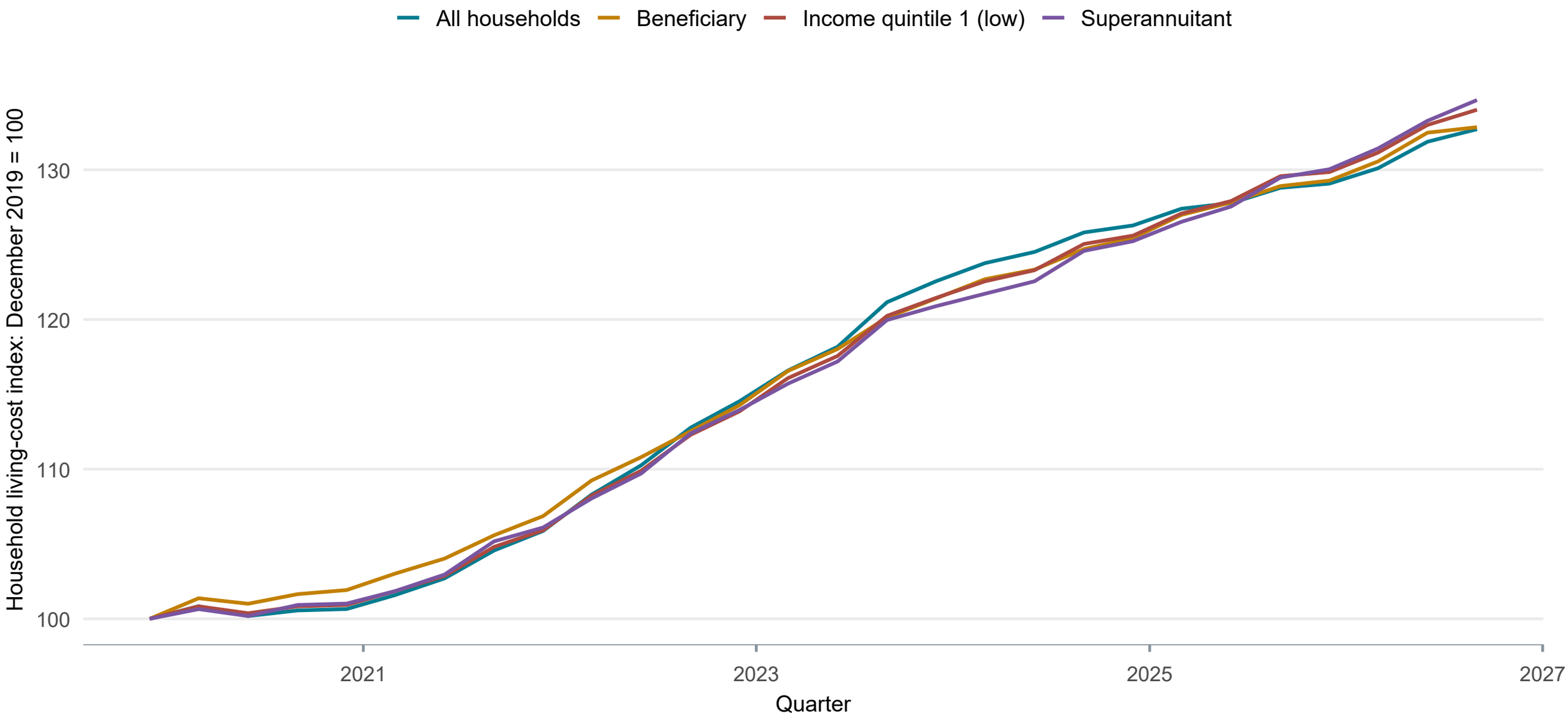

Sources: Stats NZ June 2026 GDP CSV; ABS June 2026 Table 1. Real, seasonally adjusted expenditure GDP. Growth indices do not establish which country has a higher income level.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Today's unemployment rise in historical perspective



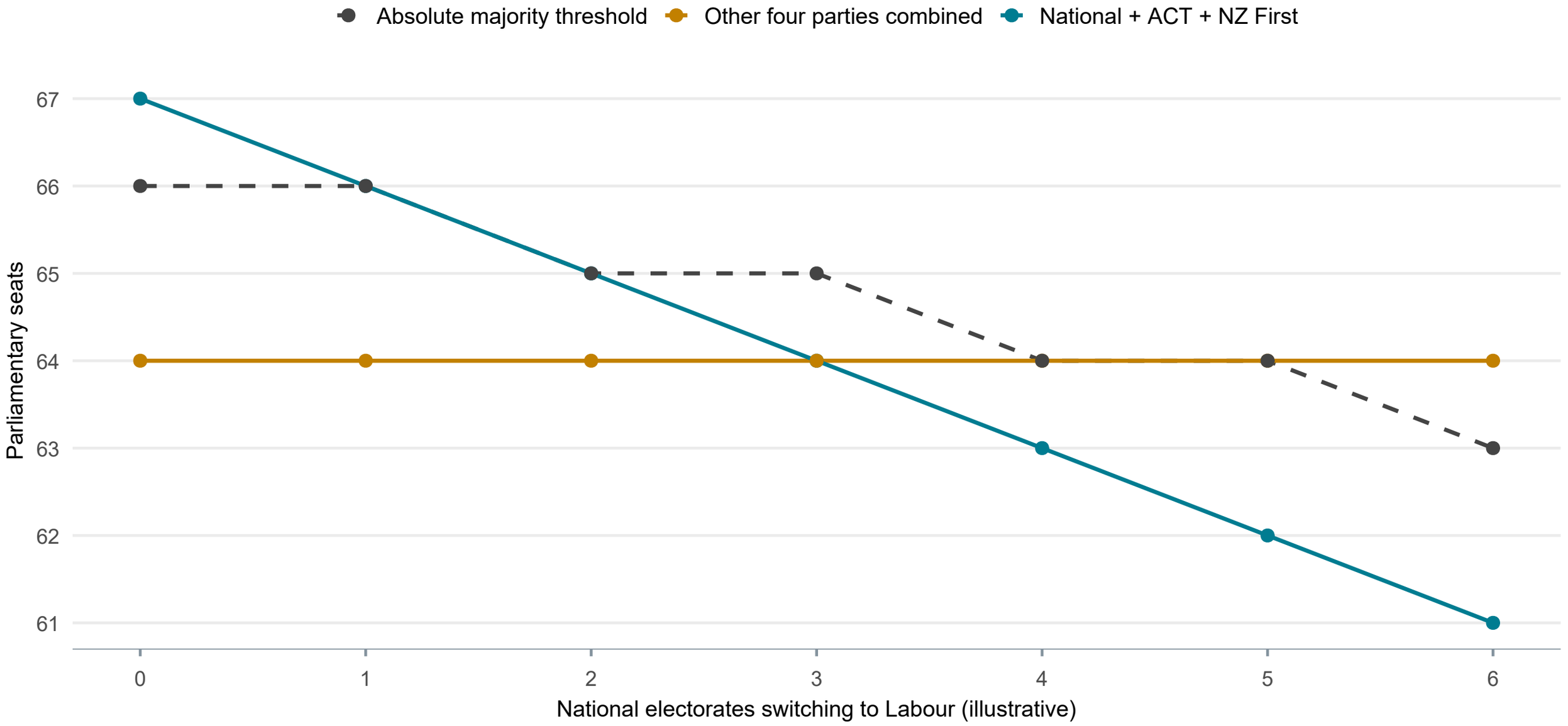

Sources: Stats NZ HLFS and ABS Labour Force, September 2026 vintages. Seasonally adjusted; Australia quarterly monthly-rate average.
Survey redesigns affect long-run comparability; see the release methodology before interpreting small differences.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Slower inflation has not reversed the increase in living costs




Source: Stats NZ September 2026 Household Living-costs Price Indexes. These household cost baskets include interest payments.
They differ from the CPI; the lines measure prices, not disposable income or affordability.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

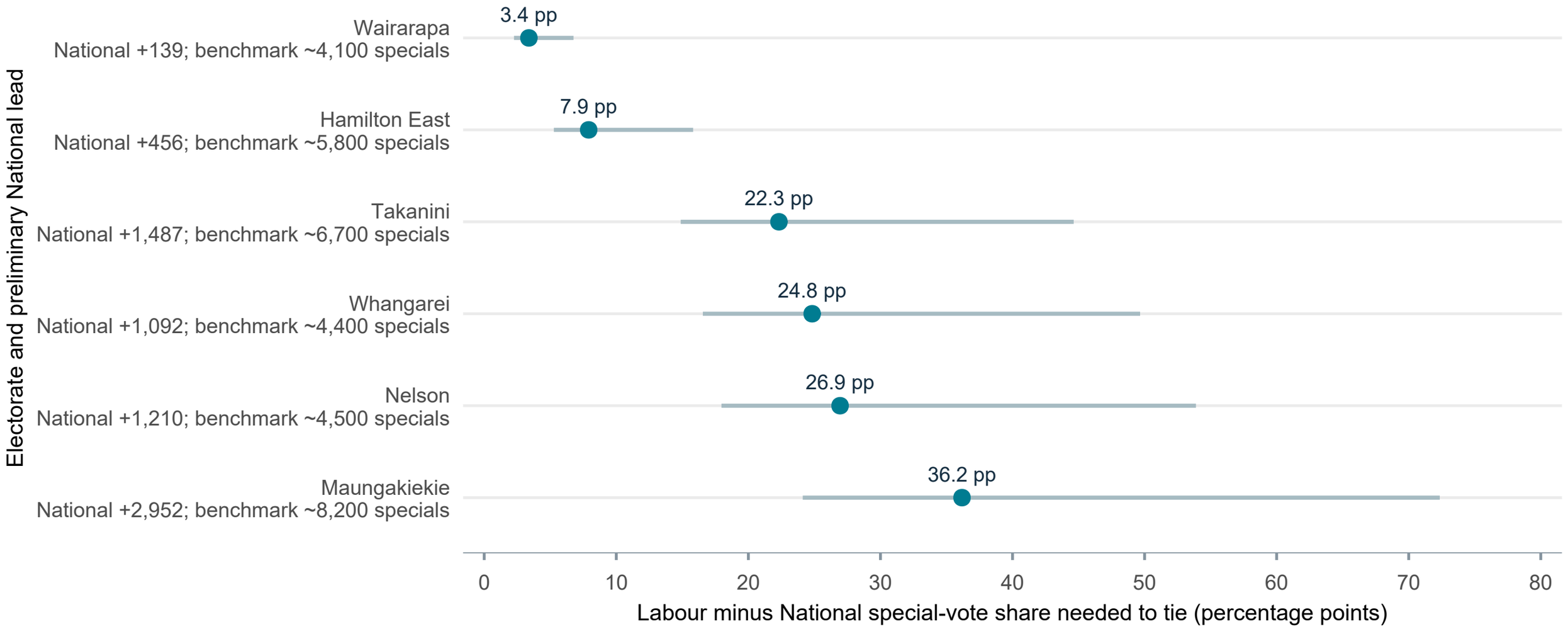
# Two electorate flips alone would not reverse the majority




Source: Electoral Commission preliminary results; mechanical scenario with fixed party-vote entitlements and National-to-Labour flips.
Labour substitutes electorate MPs for list MPs; National loses overhang seats. This is not a special-vote forecast.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# Which National leads are smallest relative to specials?

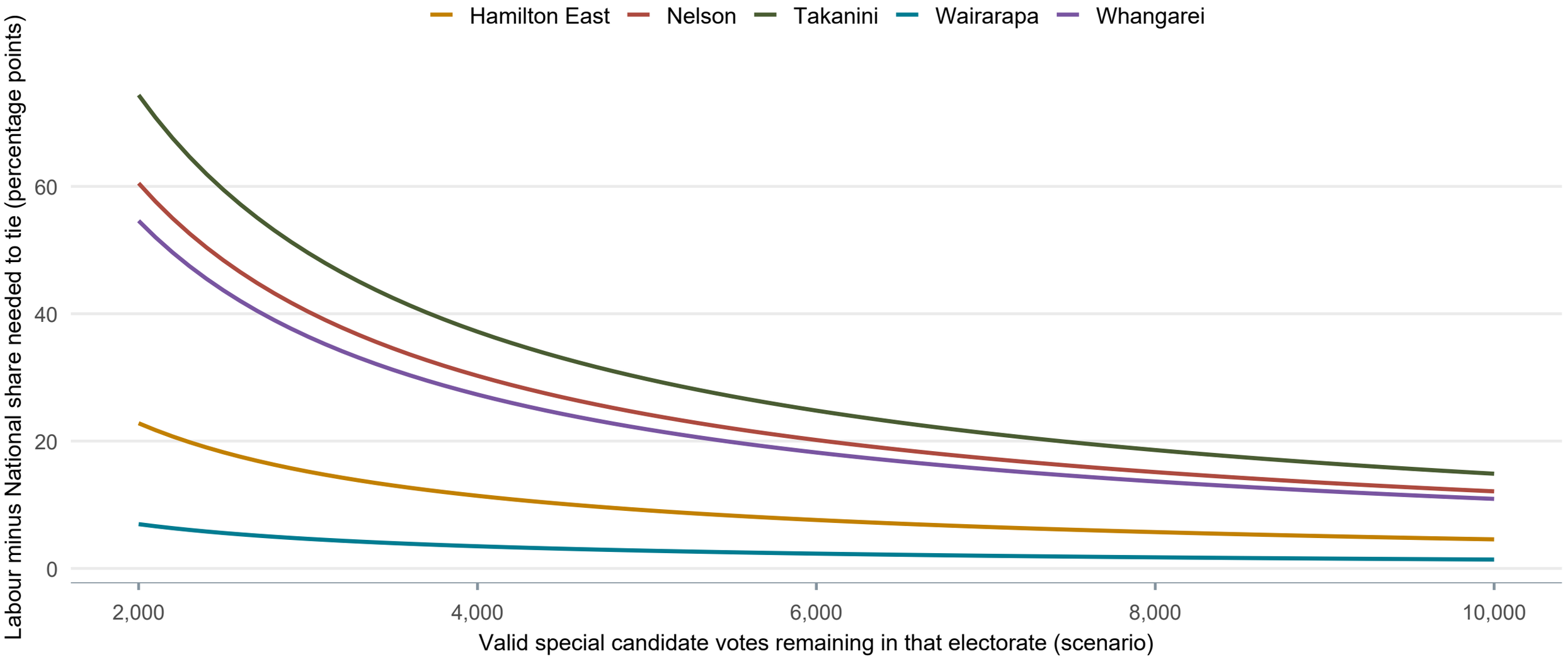
Break-even Labour minus National gap among all valid special candidate votes
Volume benchmark scales the national estimate using each electorate's 2023 specials pattern




Source: Electoral Commission 2026 preliminary counts and 2023 candidate-vote turnout table; own scenarios.
Dots: historical-pattern benchmark. Lines: 0.5 to 1.5 times that volume, not confidence intervals.
Six lowest hurdles among nine smallest National leads. No boundary/rule adjustment; recount changes excluded.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# How close National contests depend on special-vote volume

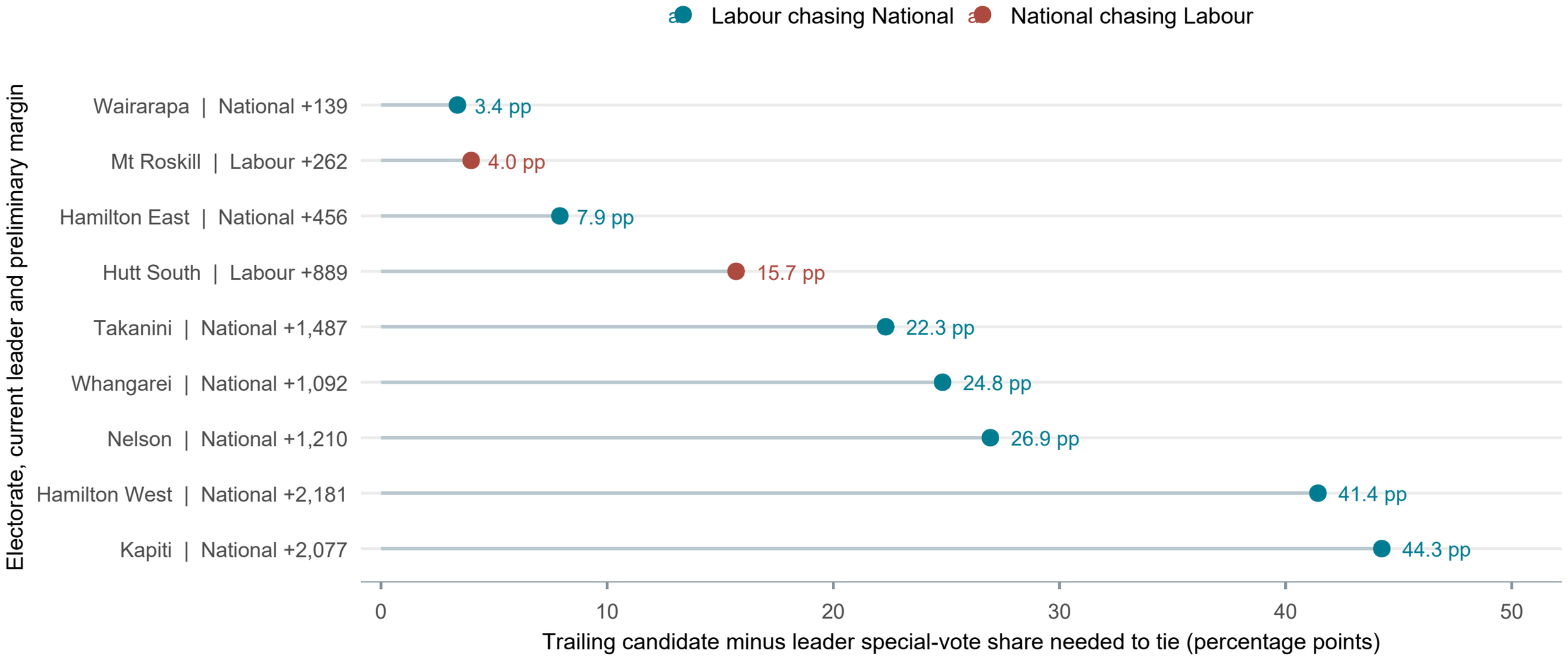
A larger pool of specials needs a smaller Labour lead to erase the same preliminary margin




Source: Electoral Commission preliminary candidate margins; own break-even calculation: 100 x margin / valid specials.
Each curve uses a range of possible volumes, not an official local count or a probability forecast.
Votes for other candidates do not transfer to Labour or National in NZ electorate voting.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# National could also gain seats on special votes

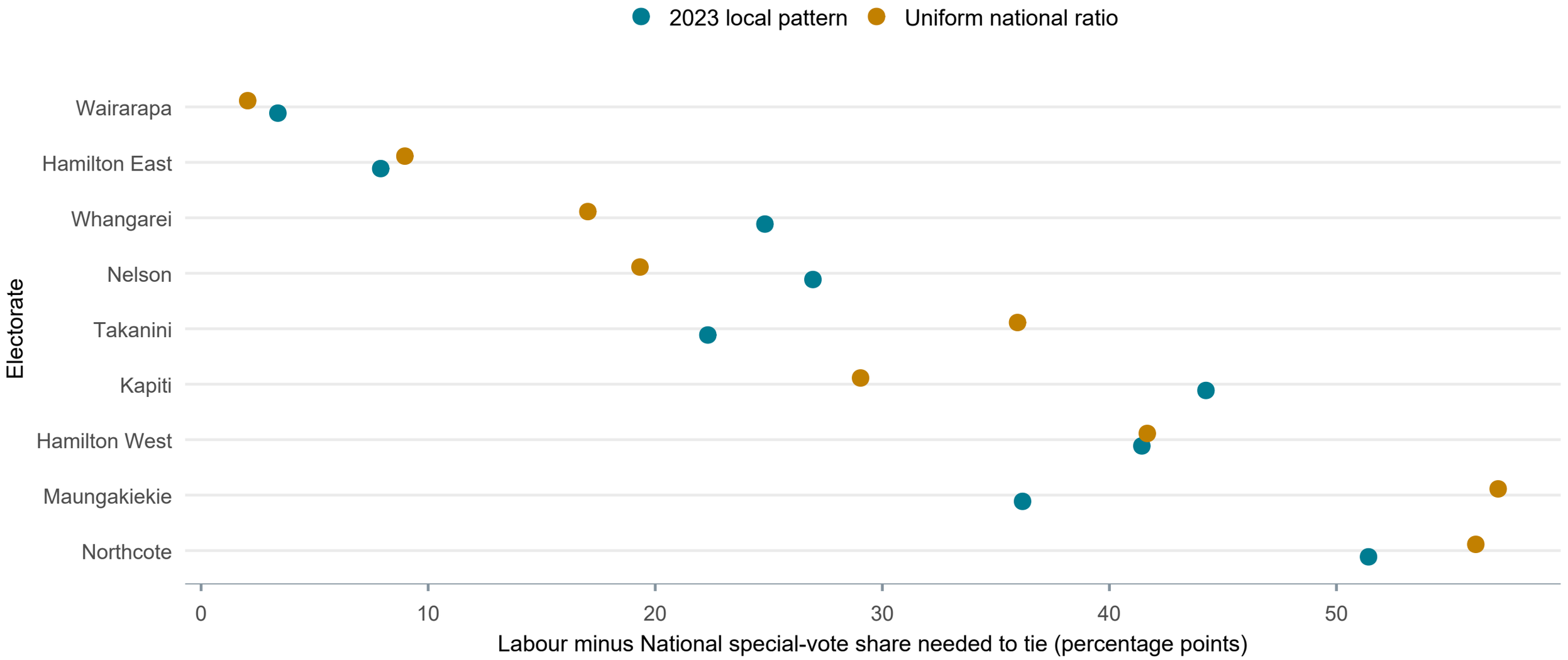
Net National losses matter for the House: gains in Labour-held seats would offset losses elsewhere




Source: Electoral Commission preliminary counts and 2023 turnout table; own historical-pattern volume benchmark.
National-Labour marginals within 2,200 votes. These are hurdles, not forecasts; smaller does not mean more likely.
Unadjusted predecessor electorates: Kapiti uses Otaki; Hutt South boundaries changed. Final party votes also matter.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.

# The ranking depends on how many specials each seat has

A high-special-vote electorate can be more vulnerable than its raw lead suggests




Source: Electoral Commission preliminary counts and official 2023 valid-candidate-vote turnout table; own benchmarks.
Both methods use the same national 2026 specials estimate. Neither is an official electorate-level estimate or a forecast.
Historical relative volumes may change with boundaries, enrolment rules, overseas voting and candidate-vote eligibility.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.